

COMMUNITYONE

One Map for Every Community

Powered by Open Navigator

Strategic Plan

2026 – 2028

Connecting residents, leaders, and funders to what's
really happening on the ground.

communityone.com

Prepared for the Candid (GuideStar) nonprofit profile

Contents

1. Executive Summary

CommunityOne is a civic-technology initiative built on a simple conviction: every person deserves to find the help they need and to have a voice in the decisions that shape their lives. Today, public resources are scattered across thousands of disconnected systems, gaps in services go unseen, and too many communities are left to navigate alone. CommunityOne exists to change that.

CommunityOne is powered by **Open Navigator**, an open-source artificial-intelligence engine that analyzes municipal meeting minutes, public budgets, and nonprofit financial data to surface opportunities for advocacy and community impact. One platform connects residents, community leaders, and funders to what is really happening on the ground — so no community has to fight just to be seen.

This strategic plan sets the organization’s direction for the three-year period spanning 2026 through 2028. It is organized around four strategic pillars: (1) expanding open civic-data coverage; (2) deepening the analytical and accountability tools that turn data into action; (3) growing adoption and demonstrable community impact; and (4) building the organizational sustainability, partnerships, and governance needed to make the work durable. Each pillar is paired with measurable goals and indicators so that progress can be tracked transparently and reported to our community, our partners, and our funders.

Guiding principle: all data on the platform is free, public, and fully cited. Every dataset, standard, and research source is published with complete attribution and licenses. Transparency is not only what we ask of governments and nonprofits — it is the standard we hold ourselves to.

2. Organizational Overview

Who We Are

CommunityOne is a mission-driven civic-data platform that brings local government, nonprofit, and community information into a single, navigable map. We combine public records that are normally siloed — council and school-board meeting minutes, municipal budgets, IRS Form 990 nonprofit filings, demographic data, and service directories — and apply AI to make that information searchable, comparable, and actionable for ordinary people.

What We Do

Our platform is organized around a five-step civic journey that meets people wherever they are:

- **Choose a cause** — roads, schools, safety, family, health, or any issue a resident cares about.
- **Make a plan** — personal and community pathways, identifying allies and desired outcomes.
- **Find help** — nonprofits, programs, and family supports relevant to the need.
- **Track decisions** — meetings, budgets, maps, and verification of what officials actually do.
- **Build with data** — open datasets, APIs, and civic tooling for developers and researchers.

How We Are Different

Most civic information is either locked away in PDFs and meeting recordings or repackaged behind paid subscriptions. CommunityOne takes the opposite approach: the Open Navigator engine is open source, the data is free, and every figure is traceable to its source. This lets a parent, an advocate, a journalist, and a funder all work from the same trustworthy record.

3. Mission, Vision & Values

Mission

To connect residents, leaders, and funders to what is really happening in their community — so that every person can find the help they need and have a voice in the decisions that shape their lives.

Vision

One map for every community: a country in which no neighborhood is invisible, no public resource is impossible to find, and no resident is shut out of the civic decisions that affect them — because the information that governs local life is open, understandable, and shared by all.

Core Values

- **Openness** — free, public data and open-source code; we do not put civic truth behind a paywall.
- **Accountability** — we compare what leaders say with what they fund and do, and we hold ourselves to the same standard.
- **Accuracy & attribution** — every dataset, standard, and source is fully cited and verifiable.
- **Equity** — we prioritize surfacing the gaps and needs of communities that are most often overlooked.
- **Empowerment** — information is only valuable if it helps people act; we design for action, not just awareness.

4. The Need We Address

Local government and the local nonprofit sector shape daily life — schools, safety, housing, health, and family support — yet the information needed to engage with them is fragmented and hard to use. Four problems recur in community after community:

- **Scattered resources.** Help exists, but residents cannot find it; service information is spread across agencies, directories, and word of mouth.
- **Invisible gaps.** Because no one combines the data, systemic gaps in services and spending go unnoticed until a crisis exposes them.
- **The rhetoric-reality gap.** Governing bodies name priorities in meetings but do not always fund them; without side-by-side comparison, the public cannot tell the difference.

- **Missed policy windows.** Advocates frequently miss the budget cycles and decision moments when their input could actually change an outcome.

CommunityOne addresses these problems directly by integrating the underlying public data and giving every stakeholder — resident, leader, and funder — a shared, evidence-based view of their community.

5. Theory of Change

Our model moves communities from information to impact through a clear logic:

Open data → AI analysis & verification → Accessible insight → Informed action → Community impact

Inputs

Free, public, fully cited data — meeting minutes, budgets, Form 990 filings, demographics, and service directories — integrated through the open-source Open Navigator engine.

Activities

AI analysis of meeting transcripts and budgets; gap detection between stated priorities and funding; nonprofit effectiveness and overhead analysis; sentiment and debate analysis; cross-jurisdiction benchmarking; and identification of time-sensitive advocacy opportunities.

Outputs

A searchable map of jurisdictions, organizations, and causes; accountability comparisons; ranked advocacy opportunities tied to upcoming decisions; and open datasets and APIs for developers and researchers.

Outcomes & Impact

In the near term, residents find help faster and engage in decisions at the moment it matters. Over time, funders and leaders allocate resources more effectively, civic participation broadens, and communities that were previously overlooked become visible and better served.

6. Strategic Goals & Objectives (2026–2028)

The following four goals define the organization’s focus for the planning period. Each goal includes specific objectives and the strategies we will use to pursue them. Targets and indicators are consolidated in Section 7.

Goal 1 — Expand Open Civic-Data Coverage

Grow from deep coverage in a small number of states to broad, reliable national coverage, so that more communities can see themselves on the map.

- Increase the number of government jurisdictions, school districts, and elected officials represented on the platform.
- Expand complete IRS Form 990 nonprofit coverage from the current set of states toward national scope.

- Grow the volume of analyzed meeting minutes and integrated video sources.
- Maintain interoperability with civic-tech standards (e.g., Council Data Project schema, OCD-IDs) to ease partnership and data exchange.

Goal 2 — Deepen Analysis & Accountability Tools

Turn raw public records into trustworthy, decision-ready insight while preserving full attribution.

- Strengthen the five core use cases: holding governments accountable, finding policy windows, tracking nonprofit effectiveness, analyzing public sentiment, and comparing education spending.
- Improve the accuracy, transparency, and explainability of AI-generated analyses, with human-verifiable citations on every claim.
- Expand fact-checking and verification features that compare stated priorities with budget reality.

Goal 3 — Grow Adoption & Demonstrable Impact

Reach the residents, advocates, journalists, and funders who can act on the information, and measure the difference it makes.

- Grow active users across all three core audiences — residents, leaders, and funders.
- Build onboarding pathways tailored to advocates and policymakers, and to developers and technical users.
- Capture and publish stories and metrics of real-world impact (testimony submitted, gaps surfaced, decisions informed).

Goal 4 — Build Sustainability, Partnerships & Governance

Ensure the mission endures by diversifying support, formalizing partnerships, and strengthening organizational capacity — without compromising the commitment to free, open data.

- Diversify funding across foundations, civic-tech grants, individual donors, and earned-revenue services that do not paywall public data.
- Formalize partnerships with academic, government-data, and civic-technology organizations whose sources the platform already cites.
- Strengthen governance, financial controls, and transparency practices appropriate to a growing mission-driven organization.
- Sustain and grow the open-source contributor and volunteer community around Open Navigator.

7. Key Metrics & Targets

Progress against each strategic goal will be tracked using the indicators below. Baseline figures reflect current platform coverage; targets are directional milestones for the planning period and will be reviewed annually.

Platform Coverage (Goal 1)

Indicator	Baseline	2028 Target
Government jurisdictions	925	Substantial multi-state growth toward national scope
Nonprofit organizations	43,726	Expand toward complete national Form 990 coverage
Meeting minutes analyzed	6,913	Multiply coverage across more municipalities
Elected officials tracked	362	Significant increase with coverage
School districts	306	Significant increase with coverage
States with full IRS data	5	Expand state-by-state toward all 50

Engagement, Accountability & Sustainability (Goals 2–4)

Focus area	What we will measure
Analysis & accountability	Accountability comparisons published; share of AI claims with verifiable citations; verification/fact-check coverage
Adoption	Active users across residents, leaders, and funders; onboarding completion by audience
Community impact	Advocacy opportunities surfaced; instances of testimony or action taken; service gaps identified
Open ecosystem	Open-source contributors; API/dataset usage; standards interoperability maintained
Sustainability	Number and diversity of funding sources; months of operating reserve; formal partnerships established

Note on data: Baseline coverage figures are drawn from the platform’s published documentation and may differ from broader catalog totals shown elsewhere. All figures are maintained transparently and updated as coverage grows.

8. Impact Measurement & Transparency

Measurement is built into the mission. Because the platform itself is a measurement tool, CommunityOne can report on its work with the same rigor it applies to the governments and nonprofits it analyzes. We will:

1. Publish coverage and usage metrics openly, updated on a regular cadence.
2. Maintain complete citations, licenses, and source attribution for every dataset and standard used.
3. Document a clear logic model and review outcomes against the indicators in Section 7 at least annually.

4. Share impact stories that connect platform insights to real civic action, with appropriate privacy safeguards.

This transparency discipline is also the basis for the organization’s commitment to the Candid (GuideStar) Seal of Transparency: goals, strategies, and metrics are documented here and progress will be reported on the organization’s public profile.

9. Financial Sustainability Strategy

The platform’s defining promise — that civic data stays free and public — shapes its financial model. Rather than charging residents for access to public information, CommunityOne pursues a diversified support strategy:

- **Philanthropic grants** from foundations focused on civic engagement, government transparency, and community health.
- **Civic-technology and open-data grants** that fund infrastructure benefiting the broader field.
- **Individual and community giving** from people who believe local information should be open.
- **Mission-aligned earned revenue** such as deployment, integration, and analytic services for institutions — structured so that core public data is never placed behind a paywall.

Over the planning period the organization will work toward a balanced funding mix and an operating reserve that protects continuity of service, while keeping administrative costs disciplined and transparent.

10. Governance & Organizational Capacity

Delivering on this plan depends on sound governance and the right capabilities. Priorities for the period include:

- **Governance.** Maintain clear oversight, financial controls, and conflict-of-interest and data-ethics policies appropriate to a civic-data organization.
- **Team & contributors.** Grow core staff and the open-source contributor community in data engineering, AI/ML, partnerships, and community outreach.
- **Technology & data stewardship.** Sustain reliable infrastructure, source attribution, and standards interoperability as coverage scales.
- **Privacy & ethics.** Apply responsible-AI practices and protect individuals when surfacing public information.

11. Implementation Roadmap

Period	Strategic emphasis
Year 1 — 2026	Solidify data quality in current states; strengthen citation/verification; launch audience-specific onboarding; establish baseline metrics and reporting cadence.

Period	Strategic emphasis
Year 2 — 2027	Expand coverage to additional states; deepen accountability and sentiment tools; grow active users and formalize key partnerships; diversify funding base.
Year 3 — 2028	Scale toward national coverage; mature impact measurement and public reporting; build operating reserve and a sustainable funding mix; expand the open-source ecosystem.

12. Conclusion

CommunityOne’s ambition is straightforward and large: one map for every community. By keeping civic data open, cited, and understandable, and by pairing it with tools that turn information into action, the organization helps residents find the help they need, helps leaders see where rhetoric and reality diverge, and helps funders direct resources where they matter most. This plan translates that ambition into measurable goals for 2026 through 2028 — and commits the organization to reporting on its progress as transparently as it asks of everyone else.

“So no community has to fight just to be seen.”